The Earliest History of Egypt

Dated to around 3,150 – 2,613 BCE, the Early Dynastic period saw North Egypt and South Egypt brought together under the rule of King Menes. He was a king who ruled Upper Egypt and controlled the north in either 3,118 BCE or c. 3,150 BCE. This information is taken from the History of Egypt by Manetho, a third century BCE historian who lived during the Ptolemy Dynasty. There is some dispute amongst scholars on Manetho's chronology but he still remains the most influential source of early Egyptian history.

Indeed, Manetho is the sole informant who tells of Menes conquering the north and uniting the two countries. It is somewhat agreed among scholars that Manetho's Menes was referring to King Narmer who was able to unite the divided lands of Egypt under his rule. However, it should be noted that not all scholars identify Menes as King Narmer. Menes is sometimes associated with King Hor Aha, or Aha, who was supposedly his successor. Menes is also thought by some to be a title that translates as *he who endures* instead of an actual name. Narmer ruled Lower Egypt, which is located in the north and faces the Mediterranean Sea, from Hierakonpolis and later Memphis. Upper Egypt is actually located in the south. The earliest rulers of the united country constructed the iconic mastaba tombs (ancestors of the pyramids) and developed their own burial methods.

The Old Kingdom Period (c. 2,613 – 2,181 BCE) saw further development of architecture. It was during this period that numerous famous structures were built, including the pyramids and the Sphinx at Giza. Reigning around 2,670 BCE, King Djoser ordered the construction of the Step Pyramid after discussion with his ministers. The Step Pyramid was finished at Saqqara around 2,630 BCE and was designed by Imhotep. Imhotep was a great physician who noted the treatment practices for more than two hundred diseases and illnesses. Little did he know, he would later go on to be deified and worshipped throughout the land.

King Khufu commissioned the construction of the Great Pyramid, which is often referred to as Cheops' Pyramid or the seventh wonder of the world. Around 2,530 and 2,510 BCE, kings Khafre and Menkaure both built their